

MILESTONES

RETURN TO CANADA

Declines an assistant professorship at Yale in 1957, in favor of a post at the University of Toronto.

SEMINAL PAPER

In 1961, with McCulloch, publishes a paper on the "radiation sensitivity of ... mouse bone marrow cells."

LEADING SCHOLAR

Becomes a Fellow of the Royal Society of Canada, the senior national council of scholars, in 1969.

PRESTIGIOUS AWARD

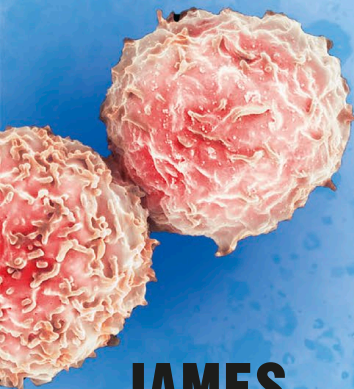
Presented with the Albert Lasker Award for Basic Medical Research in 2005, jointly with McCulloch.

Physicist James Till turned his attention to cancer research and, while working on radiation treatment, he and Ernest McCulloch made the extraordinary discovery of stem cells.

James Till grew up in a farming community in the rural border town of Lloydminster, Canada. He won a scholarship to the University of Saskatchewan to study physics, and upon graduation went to Yale University, where he completed a PhD in biophysics in 1957. Till then took up a research fellowship at the University of Toronto and was recruited to the Ontario Cancer Institute. In 1958, he began his work with McCulloch.

Later in his career, Till's research interests expanded in relation to cancer treatment. His studies included research ethics and patient quality of life, as well as the role of the internet in patient advocacy and support.

McCulloch and Till discovered that most bones of the human body contain unspecialized cells called adult stem cells. Residing in the inner marrow, they are able to develop into any blood cell.



JAMES

TILL

